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PSAC Exam Practice — Mauritius

2026

Grade 6 • Science

Specimen Paper 1

Time allowed: **1 hour 45 minutes**

Total marks: **100**

Candidate Name: _____

School: _____

Date: _____

Index No.: _____

Instructions to Candidates

1. Write your name, school and index number clearly on this paper.
2. Answer **ALL** questions in **ALL FOUR** sections.
3. Write your answers in the spaces provided on this paper.
4. All diagrams must be neat, clearly labelled and drawn in pencil.
5. The marks for each question are shown in square brackets [].
6. Calculators and electronic devices are **NOT** permitted.
7. Where working is required, show all steps clearly.

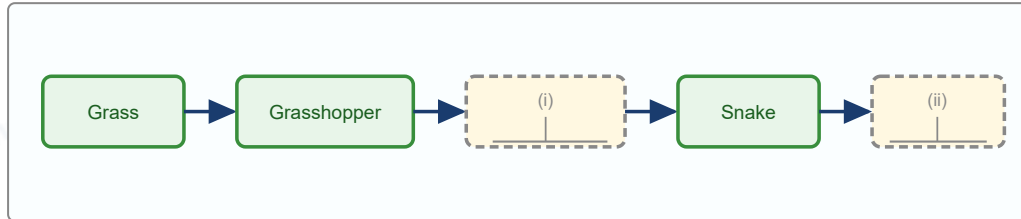
Section	Topic	Available	Awarded
A	Living Things — Food Chains & Classification	30	
B	Matter — States of Matter & Changes	25	
C	Energy — Light & Shadows	25	
D	Earth & Space — Solar System & Day/Night	20	

Section	Topic	Available	Awarded
TOTAL		100	

SECTION A — Living Things: Food Chains & Classification [30 marks]

1 Study the food chain below and answer the questions that follow.

[10]



(a) Complete the food chain above by writing the names of organisms (i) and (ii) in the boxes. Choose from: *Hawk, Frog, Eagle, Rabbit*. [2]

(i) _____ (ii) _____

(b) Identify the **producer** in this food chain and explain why it is called a producer. [2]

(c) Name **two** organisms that are *secondary consumers* in this food chain. [2]

1. _____

2. _____

(d) The grasshopper population suddenly increases due to good weather. Describe what would happen to the grass population and to the frog population. Give reasons for your answer. [3]

(e) State the original source of energy for **all** food chains. [1]

2 This question is about the classification of living things.

[10]

- (a) Vertebrates are animals with a backbone. Name the **five** main groups of vertebrates and give **one** example of an animal from each group.

[5]

Group	Example

- (b) State **one** characteristic that all mammals share.

[1]

- (c) The following organisms are listed below. Sort them into the correct groups in the table.

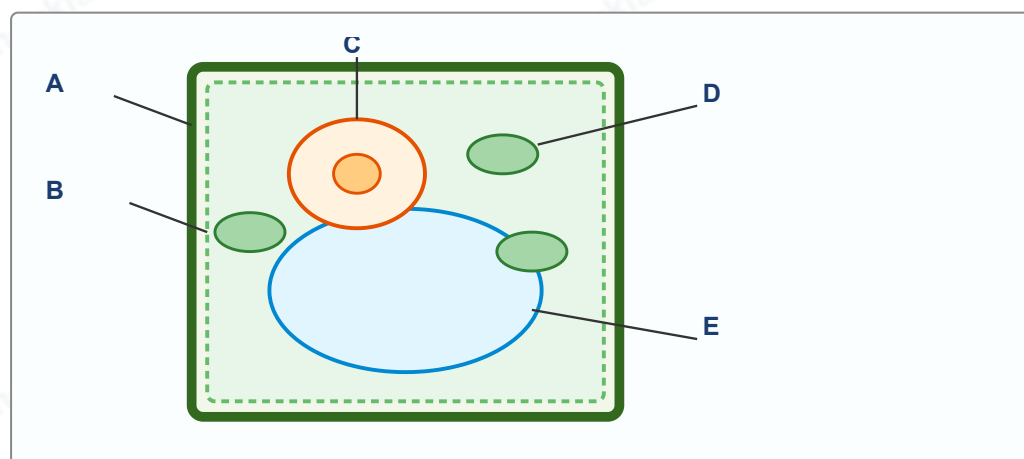
Mushroom, Rose, Butterfly, Shark, Fern, Spider, Eagle, Earthworm

[4]

Plants	Animals	Fungi

3 The diagram below shows a plant cell. Study it carefully and answer the questions.

[10]



(a) Write the name of each labelled part A–E.

[5]

A: _____

B:

C: _____

D: _____

E: _____

(b) State the function of the chloroplast (part D).

[2]

(c) State **one** difference between a plant cell and an animal cell.

[1]

(d) What is the name of the process by which plants make their own food using sunlight?

[1]

(e) What does the large vacuole (part E) store?

[1]

SECTION B — Matter: States of Matter & Changes of State [25 marks]

4 This question is about the three states of matter.

[8]

- (a) Complete the table below to describe properties of solids, liquids and gases.

[6]

Property	Solid	Liquid	Gas
Shape			
Volume			
Can it flow?			

- (b) Give **one** example of each state of matter found in everyday life.

[2]

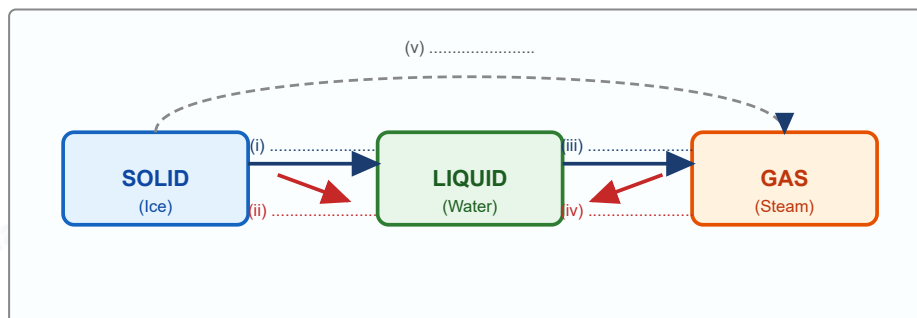
Solid: _____ Liquid: _____ Gas: _____

5 This question is about changes of state.

[9]

- (a) The diagram below shows the changes of state of water. Write the correct name for each change of state in the spaces provided.

[5]



(i) _____ (ii) _____
 (iii) _____ (iv) _____
 (v) _____

- (b) State the melting point of ice and the boiling point of water.

[2]

Melting point of ice: _____ °C Boiling point of water: _____ °C

- (c) A glass of cold water is left on a warm day. Water droplets form on the outside of the glass. Name this process and explain why it happens.

[2]

6 This question is about mixtures and methods of separation.

[8]

(a) Match each mixture with the **best** method of separation. Draw a line to connect them.

[3]

Sand and water

Magnetism

Salt and water

Evaporation

Iron filings and sand

Filtration

(b) Describe how you would separate a mixture of sand and water using filtration. Include the equipment you would need.

[3]

(c) Is salt water a pure substance or a mixture? Explain your answer.

[2]

SECTION C — Energy: Light & Shadows [25 marks]

7 This question is about light and its properties.

[8]

- (a) Sort the following into *luminous* and *non-luminous* objects in the table below.

The Sun, Moon, Mirror, Candle flame, Stars, Glass window

[3]

Luminous objects (produce their own light)	Non-luminous objects (reflect light)

- (b) In what shape (path) does light travel from a source?

[1]

- (c) Classify each material as *opaque*, *transparent*, or *translucent*.

[3]

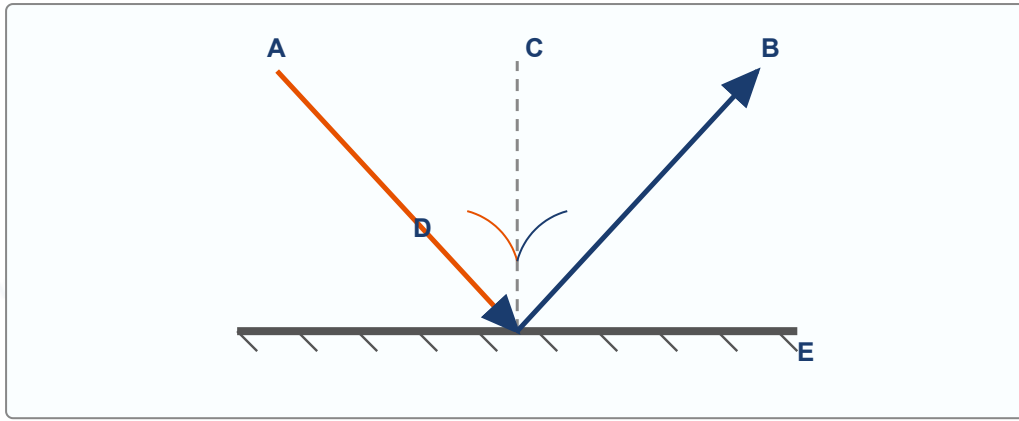
Material	Classification
Clear glass	
Wooden door	
Frosted glass	

- (d) When light hits an opaque object, a shadow is formed on the other side. Explain why the shadow has the same shape as the object.

[1]

8 The diagram below shows a ray of light hitting a flat mirror.

[9]



(a) Identify the parts labelled A–E in the diagram.

[5]

A: _____

B: _____

C: _____

D: _____

E: _____

(b) State the law of reflection.

[2]

(c) If the angle of incidence is 35° , what is the angle of reflection? Show your reasoning.

[1]

(d) Explain why we can see our face in a polished mirror but not on a rough brick wall, even though both reflect some light.

[1]

9 This question is about shadows.

[8]

(a) Explain, using the idea of light travelling in straight lines, how a shadow is formed when an opaque object is placed in front of a light

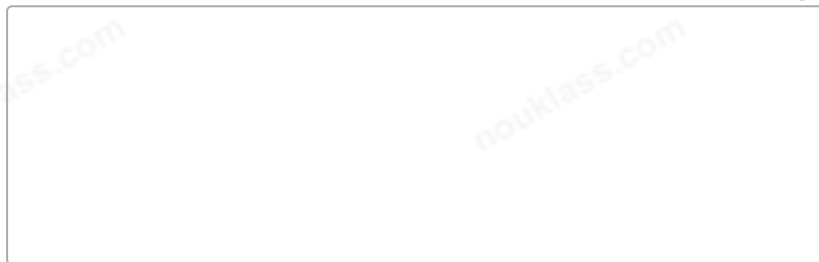
source.

[3]



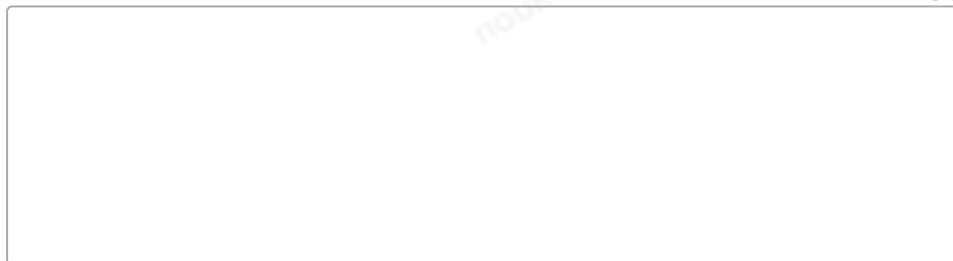
(b) At what time of day are shadows the **shortest**? Explain why.

[2]



(c) A pupil holds up a cardboard square in front of a torch. The shadow on the wall is larger than the cardboard. Explain how the pupil could make the shadow smaller without changing the size of the cardboard.

[2]



(d) What is refraction of light?

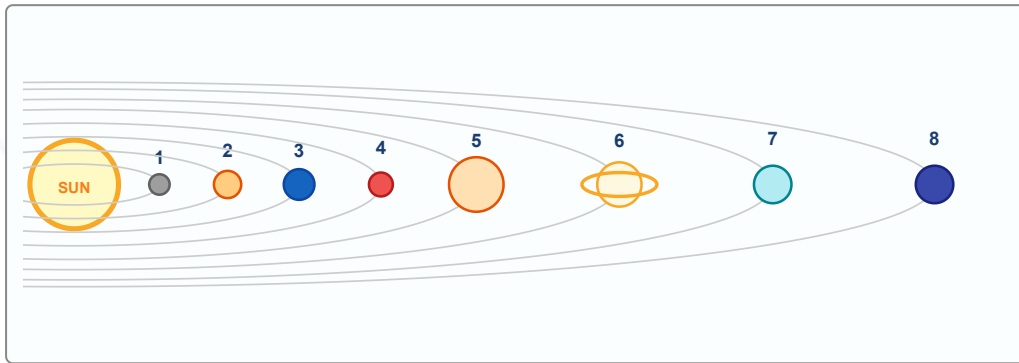
[1]



SECTION D — Earth & Space: Solar System & Day and Night [20 marks]

- 10** The diagram below shows the solar system. The planets are numbered 1–8 in order of distance from the Sun.

[8]



- (a)** Write the name of each planet numbered 1–8.

[8]

- | | |
|----------|----------|
| 1. _____ | 2. _____ |
| 3. _____ | 4. _____ |
| 5. _____ | 6. _____ |
| 7. _____ | 8. _____ |

- 11** This question is about day and night.

[6]

- (a)** Explain why we have day and night on Earth. In your answer refer to the Earth's rotation.

[3]

- (b)** How long does it take for the Earth to complete one full rotation on its axis?

[1]

- (c) How long does it take for the Earth to complete one orbit around the Sun?

[1]

- (d) The Sun appears to rise in the east and set in the west each day. Explain why this happens.

[1]

12 This question is about the Moon.

[6]

- (a) How long does the Moon take to orbit the Earth once?

[1]

- (b) Name the **four** main phases of the Moon in order, starting from new moon.

[4]

1. _____ → 2. _____ →
3. _____ → 4. _____

- (c) The Moon does not produce its own light. How are we able to see the Moon at night?

[1]

Mark Scheme — Specimen Paper 1 (2026) • Grade 6 Science

For teachers and parents: Accept any answer that demonstrates equivalent scientific understanding. Where wording differs, award the mark if the key concept is clearly expressed. Answers in *italics* are alternative acceptable responses. This paper is for practice purposes only. Produced by Noukclass.com.

Q	Part	Acceptable Answer(s)	Marks
1	(a)	(i) Frog (ii) Hawk	2
	(b)	Producer: Grass . It makes its own food through photosynthesis using sunlight. [1 for naming, 1 for reason]	2
	(c)	Frog (eats grasshopper, which eats grass) & Snake (eats frog). <i>Accept any two organisms that eat a primary consumer.</i>	2
	(d)	Grass: would decrease (more grasshoppers eat more grass). Frog: would increase (more grasshoppers = more food for frogs). [1 each + 1 for reason]	3
	(e)	The Sun	1
2	(a)	Fish (e.g. salmon), Amphibians (e.g. frog), Reptiles (e.g. lizard), Birds (e.g. eagle), Mammals (e.g. dog). [1 per correct group + example]	5
	(b)	Any one: warm-blooded / give birth to live young / suckle young with milk / have hair or fur	1
	(c)	Plants: Rose, Fern — Animals: Butterfly, Shark, Eagle, Earthworm, Spider — Fungi: Mushroom [1 per column correct]	4
3	(a)	A = Cell wall B = Cell membrane C = Nucleus D = Chloroplast E = Vacuole	5
	(b)	Chloroplasts contain chlorophyll and are where photosynthesis takes place (plant makes food from sunlight, water and carbon dioxide). [1 per point]	2
	(c)	Any one: plant cells have a cell wall / chloroplasts / large vacuole; animal cells do not.	1
	(d)	Photosynthesis	1
	(e)	Water (and dissolved substances / cell sap)	1
4	(a)	Solid: fixed shape, fixed volume, no. Liquid: no fixed shape (takes shape of container), fixed volume, yes. Gas: no fixed shape, no fixed volume, yes. [2 marks per correct row concept]	6

Q	Part	Acceptable Answer(s)	Marks
	(b)	Any correct everyday example for each: e.g. Solid=stone/ice, Liquid=water/juice, Gas=air/oxygen	2
5	(a)	(i) Melting (ii) Freezing (iii) Evaporation/Boiling (iv) Condensation (v) Sublimation	5
	(b)	Melting point: 0°C Boiling point: 100°C	2
	(c)	Process: Condensation . The cold glass cools the warm water vapour in the air; the vapour condenses (turns from gas to liquid) on the cold surface. [1 + 1]	2
6	(a)	Sand and water → Filtration Salt and water → Evaporation Iron filings and sand → Magnetism	3
	(b)	Pour mixture through filter paper in a funnel; the filter paper traps the sand (residue) while water (filtrate) passes through into a container below. [3 marks for 3 correct steps/equipment]	3
	(c)	Mixture ; salt is dissolved in water but can be separated (by evaporation), so it is not a pure substance. [1+1]	2
7	(a)	Luminous: Sun, Candle flame, Stars Non-luminous: Moon, Mirror, Glass window	3
	(b)	In straight lines (rectilinear propagation)	1
	(c)	Clear glass → transparent Wooden door → opaque Frosted glass → translucent	3
	(d)	Light travels in straight lines and cannot bend around the opaque object, so it cannot reach the area behind it, forming a dark region (shadow) with the same outline.	1
8	(a)	A = Incident ray B = Reflected ray C = Normal D = Angle of incidence E = Mirror	5
	(b)	The angle of incidence equals the angle of reflection (both measured from the normal). The incident ray, reflected ray and normal all lie in the same plane. [1 per point]	2
	(c)	35° (angle of reflection = angle of incidence)	1
	(d)	A polished mirror has a smooth surface — all reflected rays travel in the same direction (regular/specular reflection). A rough wall scatters light in all directions (diffuse reflection).	1
9	(a)	Light travels in straight lines from the source; the opaque object blocks the path of light; since light cannot pass through, a dark region forms on the screen behind the object. [1 per point, max 3]	3
	(b)	Midday (noon). The Sun is highest in the sky, so rays hit the ground at the steepest angle, making the shadow shortest.	2
	(c)	Move the cardboard further from the torch / move the torch further from the cardboard. (Increasing	2

Q	Part	Acceptable Answer(s)	Marks
		the distance between torch and object makes shadow smaller.)	
	(d)	Refraction is the bending of light as it passes from one medium (material) into another of different density.	1
10	(a)	1=Mercury, 2=Venus, 3=Earth, 4=Mars, 5=Jupiter, 6=Saturn, 7=Uranus, 8=Neptune. [1 per correct planet]	8
11	(a)	The Earth rotates (spins) on its axis once every 24 hours. The part facing the Sun experiences day; the part facing away from the Sun experiences night. [1 per point, max 3]	3
	(b)	24 hours (1 day)	1
	(c)	365 days (1 year) <i>Accept: approximately 365¼ days</i>	1
	(d)	The Earth rotates from west to east, so the Sun appears to move from east to west across the sky (it is the Earth that moves, not the Sun).	1
12	(a)	Approximately 28 days (one month)	1
	(b)	New Moon → First Quarter → Full Moon → Last Quarter (Third Quarter). [1 per phase]	4
	(c)	The Moon reflects light from the Sun.	1
TOTAL			100